```
[Download PDF](https://github.com/liquid-books/ai-copilot-bankunited/raw/main/pdfs/ch03-change-management.pdf)
```

Chapter 3: Change Management

> *"Culture does not change because we desire to change it. Culture changes when the organization is transformed — when organizations take new actions, new behaviors become the norm."*
> *— Frances Hesselbein*

Here is a scene that plays out in banks all over the country, right now.

The CEO sends an email to all staff: *"AI is a strategic priority for us. We are committed to responsible adoption. Training resources are available. Please reach out to your manager with questions."*

Ninety days later: nothing has changed.

Not because the people don't care. Not because the tools don't work. Not because the strategy is wrong. But because **a message is not a movement**. An email is not a transformation. And announcing a priority is not the same thing as building a system for adopting it.

Chapter 2 gave you the personal operating system — the mindset. This chapter gives you the organizational operating system — the *change architecture*. How you take what you now believe about AI, what you've started to practice, and what you're beginning to build — and turn that into something that outlasts you. Something that spreads.

Because the most important thing a BankUnited professional can do with their AI capability is not just use it better. It is **multiply it** — across their team, their department, and their organization.

That is what this chapter is about.

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1. Why Change Fails — And the One Thing That Works

Let us start with the uncomfortable data.

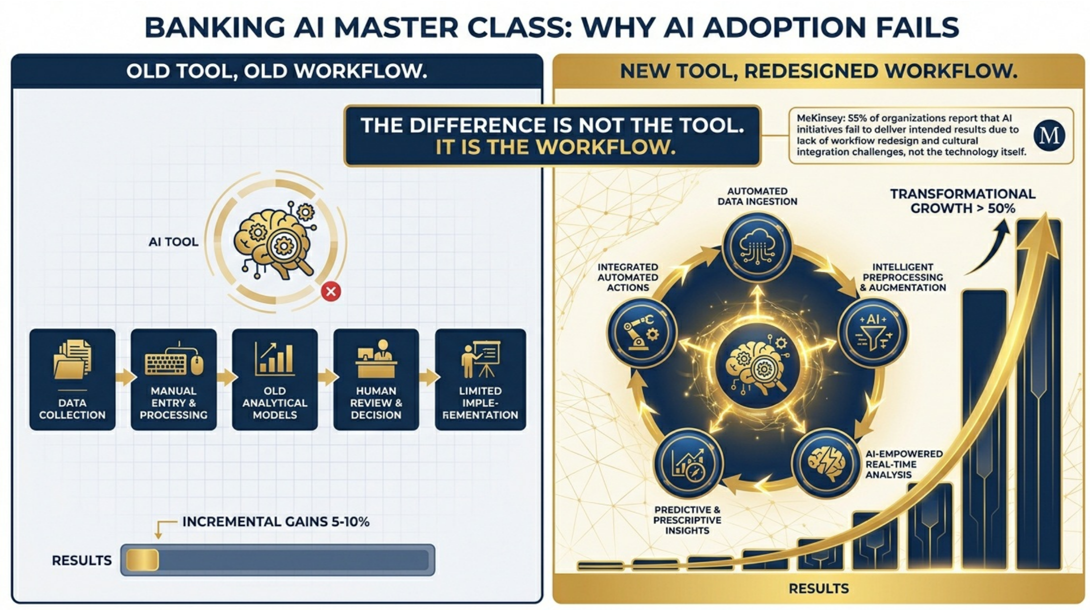
We already know from Chapter 2 that only **5% of companies globally** qualify as "future-built" for AI — meaning they have genuinely restructured how they work, not just added AI tools to their existing processes. Meanwhile, 60% report minimal or no measurable value from their AI investments despite real financial commitment.

Why?

The answer is not technology. McKinsey's research is definitive on this point: **55% of organizations that are seeing AI returns redesigned their workflows.** They did not add Copilot to the old way of doing things and expect it to be transformative. They asked: *"Given that this tool exists, what is the new right way to do this work?"* And then they built that new way.

The organizations that are not seeing returns are, almost universally, running the old process with a new tool sitting next to it. Copilot open in one tab, the same manual workflow proceeding in another. The tool gets used for occasional convenience. The fundamental way of working never changes.

This is not a technology problem. It is a **workflow redesign problem** — which is, at its heart, a change management problem.



The good news: workflow redesign does not require a top-down transformation initiative. It does not require a six-month consulting engagement. It does not require IT to rebuild anything.

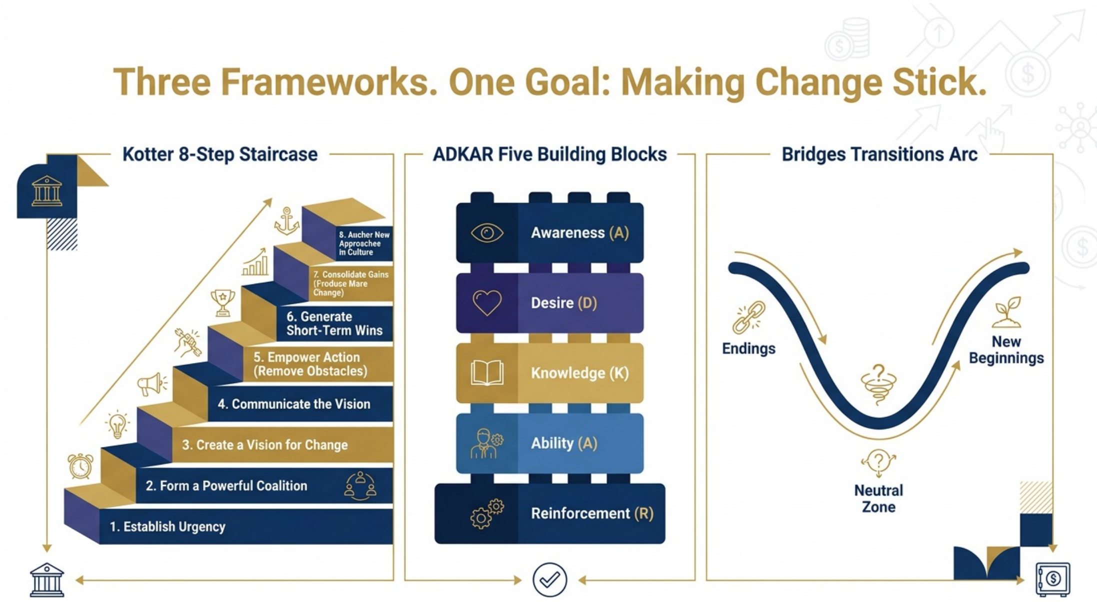
It requires one person — perhaps you — to ask: *"What if we just didn't do it the old way anymore?"* And then to prove that the new way works. And then to show someone else.

That is how every lasting technology adoption in history has actually happened. Not from the top. From the middle. From the practitioners who tried something, discovered it worked, and couldn't stop talking about it.

---

2. Three Frameworks That Actually Work

Change management as a field has accumulated an enormous library of frameworks, most of which are useful in academic contexts and largely ignored in practice. We are going to focus on three — not because they are the most academically sophisticated, but because they map directly to what is actually happening when AI adoption succeeds or fails inside a bank.



Kotter's 8-Step Model — The Organizational Staircase

John Kotter's framework, developed from studying hundreds of organizational transformations over 30 years, identifies eight conditions that must be met for change to take hold. Miss any one of them, and the change stalls. Understanding where your organization — or your team — is on this staircase tells you exactly what to do next.

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* - Step
```

```
  - What It Means
  - What It Looks Like at BankUnited
* - 1. Create urgency
  - People must feel the need to change — not just be
told about it
  - Show the 1.7× revenue gap. Show what peer banks are
deploying. Make the cost of inaction real.
* - 2. Build a guiding coalition
  - Change requires a cross-functional group of
champions, not just top-down mandate
  - Identify 3–5 respected practitioners from different
teams who believe in this and will model it
* - 3. Form a strategic vision
  - People need to see where they are going, not just
what they are leaving behind
  - "In 12 months, every RM comes to a client meeting
briefed by AI. Every credit package is first-drafted by
Copilot."
* - 4. Enlist a volunteer army
  - You need early adopters before you need everyone
  - Don't try to convert the skeptics first. Find the
curious. Start there.
* - 5. Enable action by removing barriers
  - The biggest barrier is usually permission, not skill
  - Make it safe to experiment. Create a sandbox.
Celebrate attempts, not just successes.
* - 6. Generate short-term wins
  - People need evidence it works before they commit
  - Showcase Projects (Part IV of this book) are
engineered for exactly this step.
* - 7. Sustain acceleration
  - Early wins get used to justify slowing down. Don't
let that happen.
  - Use wins to expand the program, not to declare
victory.
* - 8. Institute the change
  - Change becomes the new default — not a project, but
the way we work
  - AI-assisted workflows are in the onboarding
checklist. New hires learn them on Day 1.
```

The most common failure point in AI adoption at banks is steps 4 and 5: organizations try to enlist everyone at once (skipping the volunteer army) and fail to remove the real barriers (usually permission, not training). Fix those two steps and the rest follows faster than you expect.

ADKAR — The Individual Change Model

Kotter describes the organizational staircase. ADKAR, developed by Jeff Hiatt at Prosci, describes the individual journey. Because organizations don't change — people do. And they change one at a time.

ADKAR is an acronym for the five things an individual needs before they will sustainably adopt a new behavior:

:

{card} **A — Awareness**
Understanding *why* the change is necessary. Not "AI is a strategic priority" — but *why*, specifically, your role and your work are affected and why now is the moment.

> *Wanting to participate in the change. Awareness without desire produces compliance, not adoption. Desire comes from connecting the change to the person's own goals and interests.*

> *Knowing how to change. This is where most training programs start — and where ADKAR reminds us it's the third step, not the first. Skipping A and D and going straight to K is why most training doesn't stick.*

> *Being able to apply the knowledge. There is a gap between knowing how to do something and being able to do it under real conditions. Ability requires practice, feedback, and patience.*

> *Having the change sustained and recognized. Without reinforcement — positive feedback, recognition, peer visibility — new behaviors revert. Reinforcement is not a nice-to-have. It is what separates a training event from a culture shift.*

::::

When AI adoption stalls at BankUnited — on your team, in your department — diagnose which ADKAR stage is the bottleneck. Nine times out of ten, it is not Knowledge (people don't know how). It is Desire (people don't see why it matters to them personally) or Reinforcement (people tried it, it worked, and then nobody noticed).

Fix the right stage. Don't add more training when the problem is recognition.

Bridges' Transitions Model — The Emotional Truth

William Bridges made a distinction that most change management frameworks miss entirely: the difference between **change** and **transition**.

Change is the external event. A new tool is deployed. A new process is mandated. A new strategy is announced. Change happens on a calendar date.

Transition is the internal journey. It is how the people inside the organization move from the old way to the new one — emotionally, psychologically, professionally. Transition has three phases, and it does not start with the change. It starts with **endings**.

:

> *:class: note*
>
> ***Phase 1: Endings.*** *Before anyone can fully commit to the new way, they have to grieve the old way. The colleague who was the expert at building manual Excel models — who people came to, who was recognized for that skill — is losing something when AI handles that model in two minutes. That loss is real. Acknowledging it, rather than skipping past it with enthusiasm about the future, is what makes the transition human and sustainable.*
>
> ***Phase 2: The Neutral Zone.*** *The old way is over and the new way is not yet fully real. People are in between. They know the old workflow, but it feels outdated. They are learning the new workflow, but they are not yet confident in it. This is the most uncomfortable phase — and it is also where the most creative energy lives. The Neutral Zone is where people figure out what the new way actually looks like in their specific context. It cannot be rushed.*
>
> ***Phase 3: New Beginnings.*** *The new way becomes the default. The AI-assisted workflow is not the "AI workflow" anymore — it is just how this gets done. The beginning is complete when no one thinks of it as a transition anymore.*
>
> *The leader's job is not to push people through these phases faster. It is to make each phase safe to inhabit.*
> *:*

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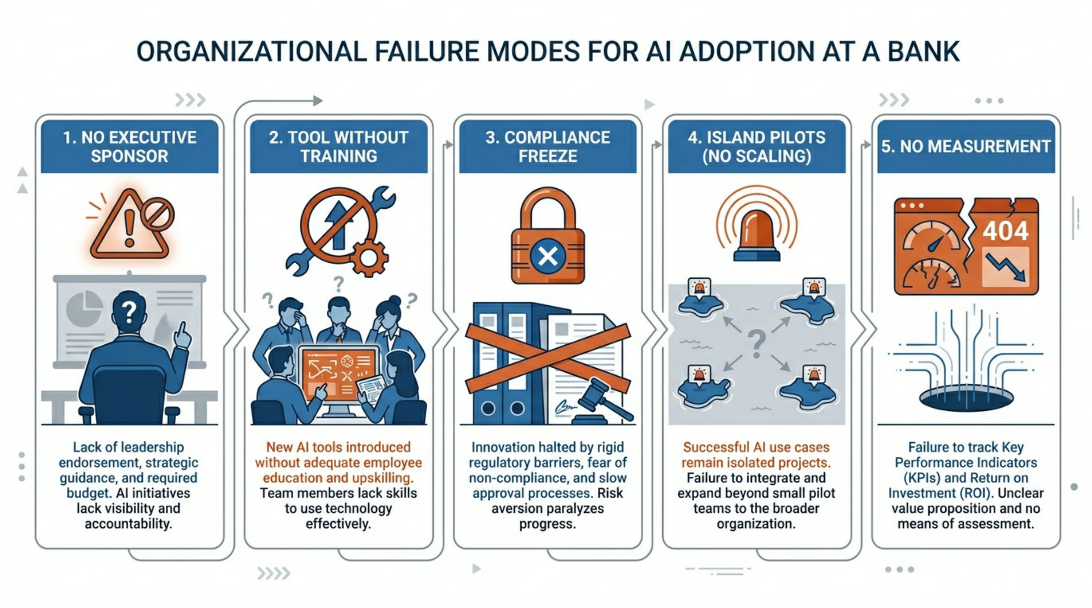
3. Why AI Adoption Fails — The Five Organizational Failure Modes



With the frameworks in place, let us name the specific failure modes that appear most consistently in AI adoption programs at financial institutions. These are not theoretical. They are drawn from the pattern across organizations that invested significantly in AI tools and measured minimal returns.

Failure Mode 1: Tool-First, Workflow-Never

The organization deploys the tool, runs a training event, and considers adoption complete. No one asks: *"What specific workflows are we redesigning?"* The tool becomes optional. The old workflows continue. The ROI doesn't materialize.

Failure Mode 2: Compliance Without Conviction

Employees complete the mandatory training, achieve their certification, and never open the tool again. Because the training addressed Knowledge (ADKAR step 3) without ever building Awareness or Desire (steps 1 and 2). The training happened. The change did not.

Failure Mode 3: Champions Without Authority

The organization appoints an "AI Champion" who is enthusiastic but has no team, no budget, no recognition, and no power to remove barriers. The champion burns out. The program fades. The lesson incorrectly drawn: "AI champions don't work." The correct lesson: champions without authority are ceremonial, not structural.

Failure Mode 4: Perfection as the Enemy of Progress
Governance teams spend six months building a perfect AI policy before anyone is allowed to experiment. By the time the policy is approved, the technology has moved twice and the policy is already outdated. Meanwhile, competitors who started experimenting six months ago have six months of learning that your organization doesn't have.

Failure Mode 5: Showcase Without Scale
A brilliant Showcase Project is built. It wins internal recognition. And then it lives on a SharePoint page that nobody visits. Because the program never built a mechanism for taking individual innovations and turning them into team or department standards.

:

> *:class: important*
>
> *In every case, the failure is not technical. The tool works. The people are capable. The failure is a **systems failure** — a missing organizational mechanism for turning individual action into collective behavior. Awareness without desire. Training without practice. Showcases without scale. Champions without authority. Governance without permission.*
>
> *The 5% of companies that are "future-built" did one thing differently: they built the mechanism, not just the moment.*
> *:*

---

4. Finding and Fueling the AI Champions

Every successful bottom-up AI adoption story has the same cast of characters at its center: a small group of enthusiastic early adopters who were empowered to experiment, recognized when they succeeded, and given a visible platform to share what they learned.

These are your **AI Champions**. And finding them is more important than almost any other organizational action in the early stages of an AI program.

A common mistake: organizations look for their most technical people to be AI Champions. This is almost always wrong. Technical sophistication is not the primary qualification. The qualities that make an effective AI Champion in a banking context are:

1. **Credibility with peers.** The Champion's colleagues already respect their professional judgment. When they say, *"I tried this and it changed how I work,"* people listen — because they trust the source.

2. **Genuine curiosity.** Not enthusiasm manufactured for a role — but authentic interest in figuring out what is possible. You can hear it when you talk to them: they are asking questions, not just reporting answers.

3. **Willingness to learn publicly.** This is the rare quality. Most professionals are comfortable sharing successes. The Champion who says *"I tried this, it didn't work, here's what I learned"* — in front of their team, without embarrassment — is the one who makes it safe for everyone else to try.

4. **A real workflow to test on.** The best Champions are not experimenting in the abstract. They are applying AI to the actual work they do every day and reporting back from the front line.

The Bottom-Up Pattern — How It Actually Happens

The most instructive case studies in AI adoption are not the top-down strategic transformations. They are the grassroots ones — the ones that started with a single person who tried something, and spread.

ING Bank — one of Europe's most successful AI adopters — did not mandate AI adoption. They created communities of practice: informal groups where employees who were experimenting with AI could share what they were learning. No policy. No certification. Just structured sharing. Within 18 months, AI-assisted practices had spread to over 60% of their knowledge-worker population — driven almost entirely by peer-to-peer sharing.

JPMorgan Chase deployed what they internally called a "floor captain" model: one identified AI enthusiast per department floor, whose job was not to train colleagues but simply to be available, to demonstrate, and to celebrate when someone tried something and it worked. The floor captain model accelerated adoption faster than any centralized training program.

Sears — the 50-app story from Chapter 2 — was built on a similar pattern. The employees who built those applications were not following a mandate. They were solving problems they personally found frustrating, using tools they had been given access to, and showing their results to their colleagues. The organizational contribution was not the mandate. It was the **access and the permission**.

At BankUnited, the same pattern is available. The question is: who in your team — or in your department — has that Champion spark? And what does it cost to give them access, time, and permission?

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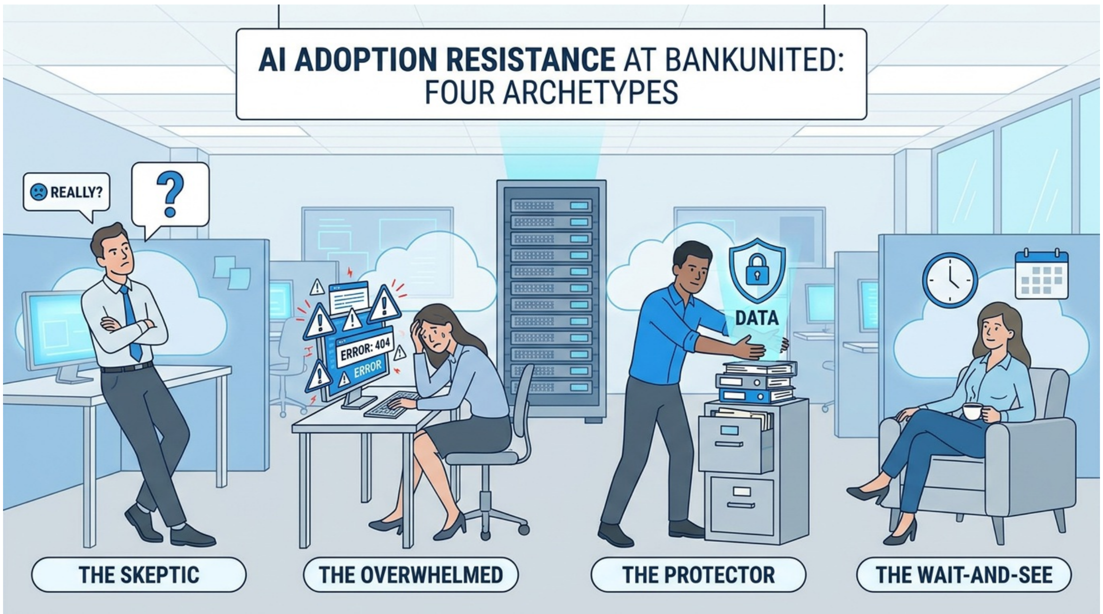
5. The Four Archetypes of Resistance

Not everyone is a Champion. And that is not a problem — it is a reality that effective change management accounts for rather than ignores.

In our experience working across organizations at different stages of AI adoption, resistant professionals tend to cluster into four archetypes. Each archetype has a different underlying concern, and each requires a different response.



The Cynic

What they say: *"We tried something like this three years ago. It didn't work. This is just the new version of the same hype cycle."*

What they actually mean: *"I have been burned before and I don't want to invest emotional energy in something that will be abandoned."*

The right move: Don't argue with the cynicism — validate it. Organizations *have* hyped technology and abandoned it. The Cynic's skepticism is earned. What changes the Cynic is not more communication about strategy — it is a concrete, visible demonstration that this time is different. Show them a real workflow that actually changed. Show them the time saved, the result improved. Give them evidence, not enthusiasm. The Cynic becomes a convert when the proof arrives. And when they convert, they become among the most credible advocates — because everyone knows they were the hardest to convince.

The Perfectionist

What they say: *"I want to use it, but I need to make sure I'm doing it right. I don't want to send something out that was AI-generated and be embarrassed."*

What they actually mean: *"My standards are high, and I'm afraid AI output will undermine them."*

The right move: The Perfectionist is not resistant — they are risk-averse in a way that is actually professionally appropriate for a banking environment. Give them structure: the verification discipline, the review protocol, the clear rule that AI drafts and humans decide. Give them explicit permission to treat AI output as a first draft that they improve, not a finished product they endorse. The Perfectionist, once they see that AI raises their quality floor rather than lowering their quality ceiling, often becomes an extremely disciplined and effective AI user.

The Territorial Expert

What they say: (rarely out loud) *"If AI can do what I do, I'm not needed anymore."*

What they actually mean: *"My professional identity and my job security are connected to specific expertise, and this tool appears to be a direct threat to both."*

The right move: This is the identity layer from Chapter 2, manifesting at the individual level. The wrong move is to dismiss the concern as irrational. It isn't. The right move is direct, honest acknowledgment: *"What AI is replacing is the mechanical part of your expertise. What it cannot replace is the judgment, the client relationships, the contextual knowledge, and the ability to apply all of it in real situations. Your value does not decrease when AI does the drafting. It increases — because now your judgment operates at a higher level with better inputs."* Then prove it by giving them an AI tool that visibly amplifies their expertise rather than substituting for it.

The Overwhelmed

What they say: *"I want to do this, I just don't have time to learn something new right now. Can we revisit in Q3?"*

What they actually mean: *"My capacity is genuinely at its limit and I need someone to make the on-ramp shorter."*

The right move: Reduce the barrier. Fifteen minutes, one use case, right now — not a training program. Not a certification. Not a self-directed learning module due in two weeks. Sit next to them, open Copilot, and apply it to something they are actually working on today. The Overwhelmed professional, once they experience the time-savings themselves, becomes motivated to invest the learning time — because they have seen the return. The barrier is not willingness. It is the apparent size of the investment before the payoff.

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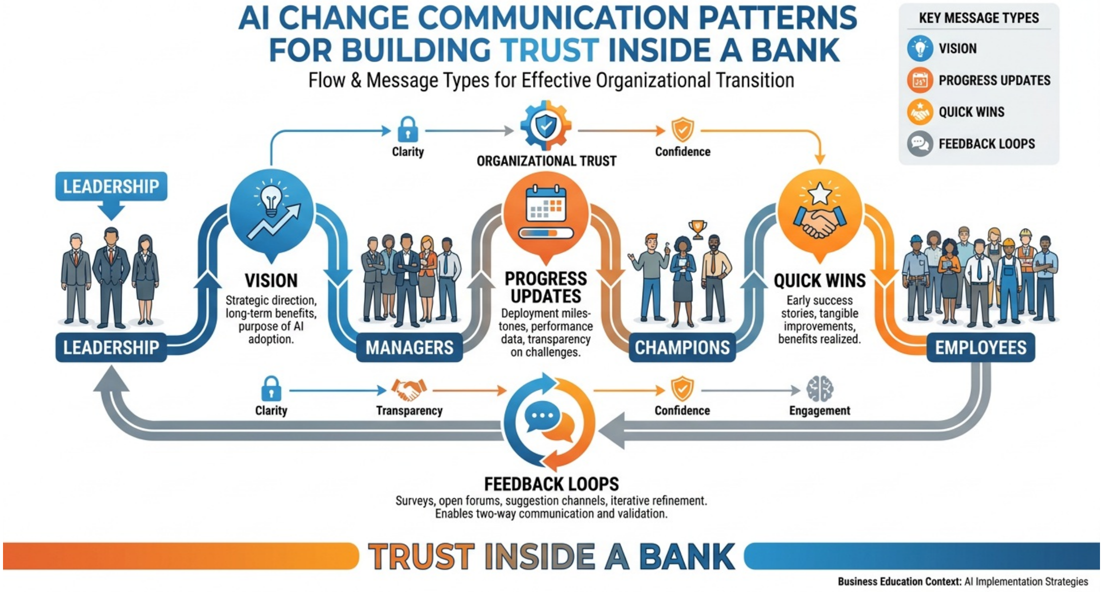
6. Communication Patterns That Build Trust



The way leaders talk about AI inside BankUnited matters enormously — more than most leaders realize. The wrong communication pattern creates fear, breeds cynicism, and makes the resistance archetypes entrench further. The right pattern builds the psychological safety that allows people to experiment, fail, learn, and grow.

Here are the communication patterns that work — and the ones that undermine what they intend:

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* - What You Might Say
  - What People Hear
  - What to Say Instead
* - "AI is a strategic priority for BankUnited."
  - "This is mandatory and you'd better comply."
  - "AI is a professional development opportunity I want to personally support."
* - "We need to stay ahead of the curve."
  - "We're behind and I'm worried."
  - "We're at an inflection point where early movers build lasting advantages."
* - "This will make everyone more efficient."
  - "We're going to do more with fewer people."
  - "This will take the tedious parts off your plate so you can focus on the work that actually requires your judgment."
* - "I expect everyone to complete the AI training."
  - "Check the box. Move on."
  - "I'm doing the training too. Here's what I learned. What did you learn?"
* - "Our competitors are using AI."
  - "We're reacting to fear."
  - "The professionals who build AI habits now will have advantages that compound for years."
* - (Silence after a failed AI experiment)
  - "Trying and failing is not safe here."
  - "Tell me what happened. What would you try differently? Good experiment."
```

The most powerful communication pattern of all is the one that is hardest for most leaders: **public modeling**. Talking about your own AI experiments — what worked, what didn't, what surprised you — in team meetings, in one-on-ones, in informal conversations. Not as a performance of innovation, but as a genuine sharing of a professional learning process.

When leaders do this, they create permission. Permission for their team to try things that might not work. Permission to talk about AI as a real, evolving practice rather than a polished deliverable.

Permission to be in the Neutral Zone together, figuring it out collectively.

That permission is worth more than any training program you can buy.

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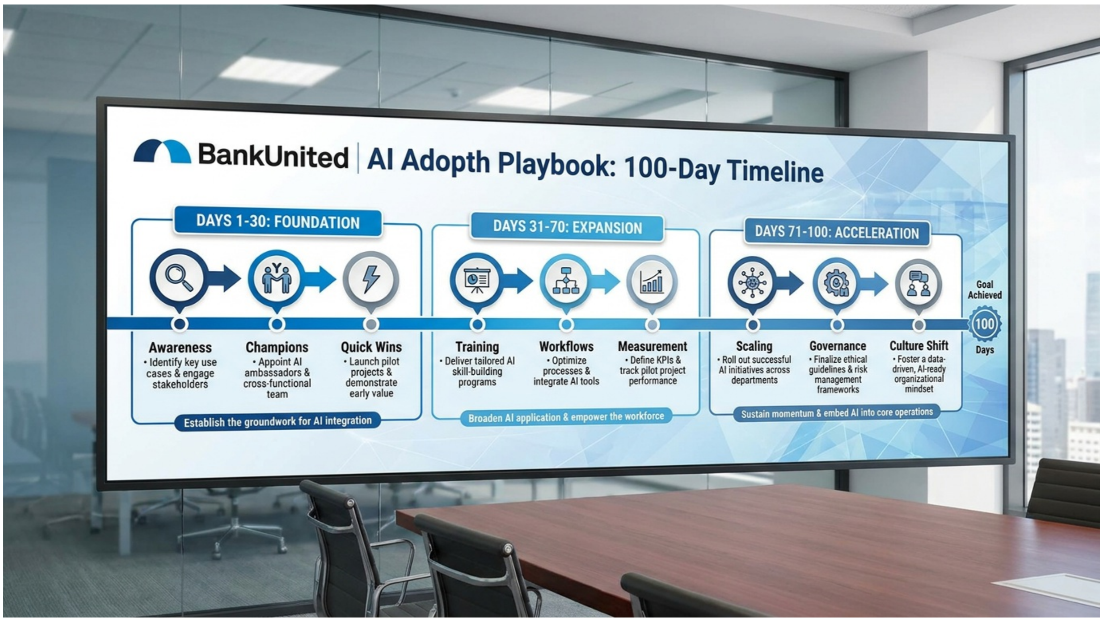
7. The 100-Day Playbook

Every successful AI adoption program needs a structured beginning. Not because structure is more important than culture — but because structure creates the conditions in which culture can form. Without a defined sequence, adoption dissolves into the urgency of daily operations and never gains momentum.

Here is the 100-day playbook that has proven most effective in financial services environments:



Days 1–30: Awareness — Ignite the Curiosity

The goal of the first 30 days is not adoption. It is **curiosity**. You want people asking questions, not completing checkboxes. The specific activities:

- **Week 1:** Leader communication — personal, specific, and modeling-focused. Not a strategy announcement — a genuine "I tried this and here's what I found" message from the most credible voice available.

- **Week 2:** Identify Champions. Three to five volunteers across different functions and seniority levels. Give them access, time, and a clear mandate: experiment and share.
- **Week 3:** First "AI Lab" session — informal, one hour, Champions demonstrate something real. No slides, no certification. Just: *"Here's what I tried. Here's what happened. Here's what you can try today."*
- **Week 4:** Open channel (a Teams channel, a Viva Engage group, a SharePoint page — whatever exists) where people can share AI experiments, tips, and questions. Seed it with Champion contributions. Make sharing feel low-stakes.

Days 31–60: Pilots — Prove Real Value

The goal of the second 30 days is **evidence**. Specific, measurable, visible results that make the case from the inside better than any external report.

- **Week 5–6:** Champions identify one repeatable workflow in their area and redesign it with AI assistance. Not a demo — a real workflow that the team actually uses.
- **Week 7:** First internal "what's working" session. Champions present: *"We changed how we do X. Here is what it looked like before. Here is what it looks like now. Here is the time saved / quality improved."*
- **Week 8:** Expand access. Based on what pilots revealed, identify the next cohort of practitioners who should be building with AI.

Days 61–100: Scale — Spread What Works

The goal of the final 40 days is **institutionalization**. Making the AI-assisted workflow the default, not the exception.

- **Week 9–10:** Document the redesigned workflows as standard operating procedures. Add them to onboarding materials. Make AI-assisted practice the baseline expectation for new hires.

- **Week 11–12:** First Showcase event — internal, celebrated, visible. Not a compliance exercise — a genuine recognition of the professionals who built something and changed how their team works.
- **Week 13–14:** Review what the 100 days revealed. What worked? What stalled? Who surprised you? What should the next 100 days look like?

The playbook is a beginning, not a destination. Its job is to build enough momentum that the change starts sustaining itself — that AI practice becomes the norm from which deviation requires justification, rather than the experiment that needs permission.

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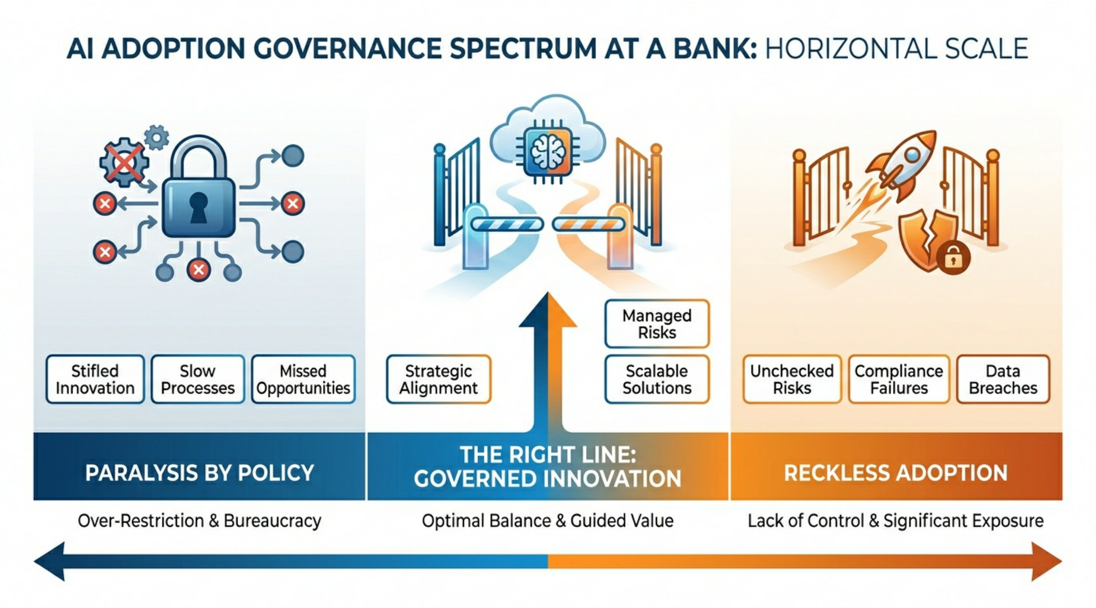
8. Governance vs. Permission — Finding the Line Between Protection and Paralysis



This is the hardest conversation in every AI adoption program inside a regulated institution. And it is worth having directly.

BankUnited operates in one of the most carefully supervised industries in the world. OCC guidance, Federal Reserve expectations, FDIC standards, state banking regulators — every workflow that touches client data, financial advice, or regulatory reporting carries legal and compliance weight. That weight is real. The people who carry it are doing important work.

And here is the tension: **the same caution that protects the bank from compliance risk can, if miscalibrated, protect the bank out of its competitive position.**

The question is not whether to govern AI use. Governance is non-negotiable in banking. The question is: **what kind of governance, applied where, at what stage?**

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* - Governance That Enables
  - Governance That Paralyzes
* - "Here is what you are permitted to do. Start there."
  - "You must get approval before you do anything."
* - "Here is the approved use case library. Add to it."
  - "AI use requires a formal risk assessment per
workflow."
* - "Here is what not to put in AI. Everything else is
fair game."
  - "AI use is under review pending policy development."
* - Fast lane for low-risk experiments, scrutiny for
high-risk ones
  - One governance process for all AI use regardless of
risk
* - Policies that evolve with the technology
  - Policies finalized before the technology is
understood
* - "Go. Here are the guardrails."
  - "Wait. Here is the approval process."
```

The financial institutions that are winning the AI race — JPMorgan, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, ING — all have rigorous AI governance. None of them have governance that requires pre-approval for a professional to use Copilot to draft an internal memo.

The principle is **proportionality**: governance intensity should match risk level. Using Copilot to draft talking points for an internal meeting is a different risk profile than using AI to generate client-facing financial projections. Treat them differently. Reserve the full compliance apparatus for the workflows where it genuinely matters, and create a fast lane for the vast majority of daily AI use that is inherently low-risk.

The goal is: **go with guardrails**, not wait with approval.

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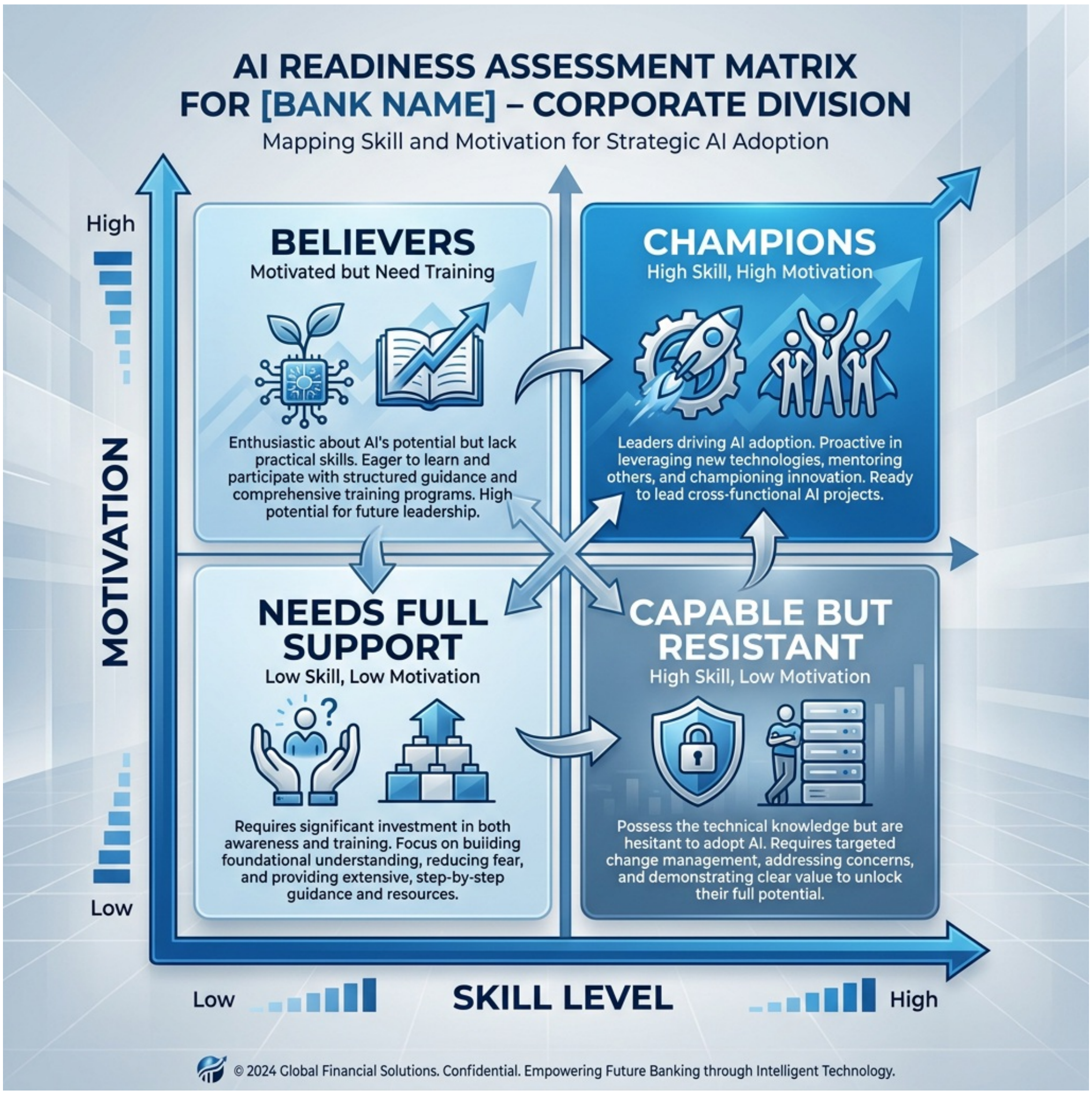
9. Map Your Team's AI Readiness

Here is the tool that makes everything in this chapter actionable at the individual leader level.

The **AI Readiness 2×2** maps your team members across two dimensions: their current AI skill level (from low to high) and their willingness to change (from low to high). The four quadrants that result require four different leadership moves.


AI READINESS ASSESSMENT MATRIX FOR [BANK NAME] – CORPORATE DIVISION
Mapping Skill and Motivation for Strategic AI Adoption
High
MOTIVATION
Low
BELIEVERS
Motivated but Need Training
Enthusiastic about AI's potential but lack practical skills. Eager to learn and participate with structured guidance and comprehensive training programs. High potential for future leadership.
CHAMPIONS
High Skill, High Motivation
Leaders driving AI adoption. Proactive in leveraging new technologies, mentoring others, and championing innovation. Ready to lead cross-functional AI projects.
NEEDS FULL SUPPORT
Low Skill, Low Motivation
Requires significant investment in both awareness and training. Focus on building foundational understanding, reducing fear, and providing extensive, step-by-step guidance and resources.
CAPABLE BUT RESISTANT
High Skill, Low Motivation
Possess the technical knowledge but are hesitant to adopt AI. Requires targeted change management, addressing concerns, and demonstrating clear value to unlock their full potential.
Low
SKILL LEVEL
High
© 2024 Global Financial Solutions. Confidential. Empowering Future Banking through Intelligent Technology.

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* - Quadrant
  - Who They Are
  - What They Need
  - Your Move
* - **Champions** (High skill, High willingness)
  - Your early adopters — already experimenting, already
building
  - Visibility, authority, a platform to share
  - Appoint them. Give them time and recognition. Let
them run the AI Lab sessions.
* - **Eager Learners** (Low skill, High willingness)
  - Enthusiastic but untrained — asking questions,
showing up to everything
  - Structured access, quick wins, a clear starting point
  - Give them Chapter 1 of this book. Sit beside them for
30 minutes. Remove the blank-page barrier.
* - **Coachable Stars** (High skill, Low willingness)
  - Technically capable but emotionally resistant — often
the Territorial Expert archetype
  - Psychological safety, acknowledgment of loss, visible
proof
  - One-on-one conversation. Acknowledge what they're
protecting. Show how AI amplifies it.
* - **Skeptics** (Low skill, Low willingness)
  - Haven't started and don't want to — often the Cynic
or Overwhelmed archetypes
  - Evidence, not training. A win they can see, not a
process they have to follow.
  - Don't start with them. Start with Champions. Let
their results create FOMO.
```

The strategic insight in this matrix: **do not start with the Skeptics**. It is a natural impulse — the resistant are visible, and organizational culture is sometimes held hostage by them. But starting with skeptics is fighting uphill. Start with your Champions and Eager Learners. Build real results. Make those results visible. The Skeptics will move when they see evidence — and some will not move until they see their colleagues succeeding without them, which creates the only motivation that actually works for the deeply resistant: social proof combined with mild competitive pressure.

Try This — Build Your Team's AI Change Map

These exercises are practical change management tools you can use immediately. They work whether you are a team lead, a department manager, or a senior individual contributor who cares about your team's trajectory.

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:class: tip

Time required: *30 minutes*

Step-by-step:

1. *Open a new document in **Microsoft Word** ([office.com (https://office.com)](https://office.com) → sign in → New Document).*
2. *Create a simple 2×2 grid with the axes described above (Willingness to Change / AI Skill Level).*
3. *Place each member of your team (by first name or initials) in the quadrant that best reflects where they are today.*
4. *For each Champion and Eager Learner in your map, write one specific action you can take in the next two weeks.*
5. *For each Skeptic, write nothing — your action with them comes after your Champions have visible results to share.*
6. *Save to OneDrive. Schedule a 30-minute conversation with your Champions this week.*

What you are building: *The organizational foundation for everything that follows in this program. The map is not permanent — you'll update it every 30 days. The act of building it forces clarity about where your team actually is versus where you hope they are.*
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:class: tip

Time required: *15 minutes*

Step-by-step:

1. *Navigate to [m365.cloud.microsoft (https://m365.cloud.microsoft)](https://m365.cloud.microsoft) → Copilot Chat. Sign in with your BankUnited Microsoft 365 credentials. Confirm the green enterprise shield is visible in the top right of the interface.*
2. *Paste this prompt, filling in your specifics:*

> *"I am a [your role] at BankUnited responsible for leading AI adoption in my team/department. I have [number] direct reports. I am going to describe my team's current state and the challenges I face. Play the role of a highly experienced organizational change management consultant who has led AI adoption programs at financial institutions. Be direct. Challenge my assumptions. Don't tell me what I want to hear. Here is my situation: [describe your team, their current AI adoption state, and the one or two biggest obstacles you see]."*

3. *Engage in at least five back-and-forth exchanges. Push back when something doesn't feel right for your context. Ask for specific tactics, not just frameworks.*
4. *At the end, ask: "What is the single highest-leverage action I should take in the next 30 days? Give me one thing, with a rationale."*

What you are practicing: *Using Copilot as a strategic thinking partner for organizational challenges — not just productivity tasks. This is the highest-leverage use of AI for leaders.*
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Time required: *20 minutes*

Step-by-step:

1. *Open Microsoft Word → New Document.*
2. *Title it: BankUnited AI Adoption — 90-Day Plan — [Your Name] — [Date].*
3. *Create four sections:*

   Champions: *Name your 2–3 identified Champions. What is your action with each in the next two weeks?*

   First Win: *What is the single workflow you will redesign with AI in the next 30 days? Name the workflow, the team members involved, and the metric you will track.*

   Communication: *What will you say, and when, to your team about AI in the next 30 days? Write one sentence that captures your message.*

   Governance Clarity: *What questions do you need answered by your IT or compliance team to enable safe AI experimentation? List them. Then schedule the conversation to get them answered.*

4. *Share this document with your manager as a discussion agenda for your next 1:1.*

What you are building: *A concrete, personal change management plan that moves AI adoption from conversation to calendar. The professionals who do this exercise leave the program with something that actually gets implemented. The ones who skip it take home good ideas that fade under the pressure of daily operations.*
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10. The AI Readiness Questionnaire — Your Culture Diagnostic Tool

Everything in this chapter — the frameworks, the archetypes, the 100-day playbook — works only if you have an honest picture of where your team actually stands today. Not where you hope they are. Not the official narrative. The real picture.

That is what this diagnostic tool gives you.

The **AI Readiness and Integration Questionnaire** is a 15-question instrument designed to surface three things simultaneously: where each individual sits on the AI maturity spectrum, how the team perceives the organization's AI capability, and where the highest-value AI automation opportunities are hiding inside your day-to-day work.

> *:class: tip*
>
> ***Step 1 — Distribute individually.*** *Send the questionnaire to your team before a team meeting or session. Anonymous responses are fine — and often more honest. Give people 10 minutes to complete it on their own, in private.*
>
> ***Step 2 — Present the aggregate results.*** *In your session, share the thematic patterns — not individual responses. "Three people said compliance review is our biggest bottleneck." "Most of us rated our AI skill at 4 or 5 out of 10." This creates a shared reality without exposing individuals.*
>
> ***Step 3 — Use it as your implementation roadmap.*** *The responses to questions 10, 11, and 12 are not just survey data — they are a direct map to your first AI pilots. When five people independently name the same pain point, that is your starting place.*
>
> ***Step 4 — Repeat in 90 days.*** *Run the same questionnaire again. The shift in scores is your culture change metric.*

→ Take the AI Readiness and Integration Questionnaire
(https://forms.gle/EW1GhoGfcWB9vnMfA)

Understanding the Five Dimensions the Questionnaire Measures

The 15 questions are not random. They are organized around five diagnostic dimensions, each revealing a different layer of readiness.

Dimension 1 — Personal AI Sovereignty (Questions 3, 4, 5)

Where are you on the AI maturity scale?

These questions assess your personal relationship with AI — not your organization's, yours. This matters because organizational AI adoption is always, at its foundation, the aggregate of individual journeys. You cannot build an AI-capable culture from people who have never personally experienced AI doing something useful.

The AI maturity scale for individuals runs from five recognizable stages:

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* - Level
  - Stage
  - What It Looks Like
  - Score Range
* - **1**
  - **AI Unaware**
  - Has not meaningfully engaged with AI tools. May have
heard of ChatGPT but hasn't used it for real work.
  - 1–2
* - **2**
  - **AI Curious**
  - Has experimented — tried a few prompts, played with a
chatbot, seen a demo. But nothing has changed how they
work.
  - 3–4
* - **3**
  - **AI Functional**
  - Uses AI tools weekly for specific, repeated tasks.
Has found at least one thing AI does reliably well.
Getting value, but still dependent on the AI's defaults.
  - 5–6
* - **4**
  - **AI Integrated**
  - AI is embedded in daily workflow. Prompts
intentionally. Has developed personal prompt libraries,
personas, and workflows. Would feel meaningfully slower
without it.
  - 7–8
* - **5**
  - **AI Sovereign**
  - Designs AI solutions. Builds agents, automations, and
custom workflows. Thinks in systems, not just tasks.
Could teach this to others.
  - 9–10
```

Most professionals at BankUnited will score between a 3 and a 6 — functionally aware, selectively capable, but not yet integrated. That is not a failure. It is the starting point. The gap between a 5 and an 8 is not talent — it is deliberate practice, structured exposure, and a permission environment that says it is safe to experiment.

Question 4 — *What's the most impressive thing you've done with AI that actually stuck in your workflow?* — is the most revealing question in the instrument. An honest answer reveals whether someone has crossed the threshold from curiosity to functional use. If someone cannot answer it, their score is probably a 3 or below, regardless of what they selected in question 3.

Question 5 — *What's been your biggest barrier?* — tells you what is between your team and their next level. Not enough time, not knowing where to start, distrust of outputs — each answer requires a different intervention. This is where your Champions become critical: peer-to-peer credibility removes barriers that no training deck can touch.

Dimension 2 — Organizational AI Perception (Questions 6, 7, 8)

How does your team see BankUnited's AI readiness?

These three questions reveal something leaders often do not know: the gap between the official AI narrative and the experienced reality. An organization can have a formal AI strategy and still have a workforce that experiences the environment as ad hoc and unsupported. That gap is a trust problem, and it is a change management problem before it is a technology problem.

Question 6 asks what percentage of the team is genuinely AI-capable. The responses here reveal something important: how visible AI adoption is to peers. If Champions are working in isolation — getting results but not sharing them — their colleagues will underestimate the actual capability level of the team.

Question 7 assesses whether people experience the organization's AI strategy as real or rhetorical. The difference between "we're exploring" and "we have a formal strategy with KPIs" is not semantics — it is the difference between employees feeling that AI initiatives have institutional backing or that they are on their own.

Question 8 — the Bus Factor question — is the most uncomfortable one in the instrument. *If your top three people left tomorrow, what would break first?* This question surfaces something that AI cannot fix: the organizational fragility of undocumented expertise. But it is also the clearest indicator of where AI-powered documentation, knowledge capture, and process codification would create the most immediate institutional value. If the answer is "almost everything would break," you have just identified your first AI pilot.

Dimension 3 — Role Context (Question 9)

What is your role?

This question replaced the original "industry" field because inside BankUnited, the relevant variable is not industry — it is function. A relationship manager, a compliance officer, an operations analyst, and a branch manager all work in banking, but they have radically different AI use cases, different risk tolerances for AI outputs, and different workflows where AI can create value.

Segmenting responses by role allows you to do targeted analysis: where are the Commercial Lending professionals experiencing friction? What are Operations teams identifying as their biggest bottlenecks? Role-based patterns produce role-specific pilot candidates.

Dimension 4 — Pain Points Addressable by AI (Question 10)

What workflows are high-volume, error-prone, or expertise-dependent?

This is the question that separates diagnostic surveys from actionable intelligence. Question 10 asks people to describe 2-3 critical business workflows that are either high-volume, error-prone, or require expensive expertise to execute — specifically those with the most manual handoffs or where errors cost the most.

The responses to this question are, in effect, a crowdsourced AI opportunity map. When multiple people from different roles identify the same workflow as painful, that convergence is your highest-confidence pilot candidate. The three characteristics that make a workflow AI-ready — high volume, clear structure, and tolerance for imperfect output — often align directly with the workflows that frustrate people most.

Thematic analysis of question 10 responses across your team will almost always surface 2-3 workflows where a well-designed Copilot prompt library, an agent, or an automation would create immediate, measurable time savings.

Dimension 5 — AI Automation Opportunities (Questions 11, 12)

Where would AI create the most value if it worked perfectly?

Questions 11 and 12 access something that structured workflow analysis often misses: employee aspiration and pain. Question 11 — *If you could wave a magic wand and have AI handle one thing perfectly starting tomorrow, what would it be?* — reveals where people are most frustrated with their current cognitive load. The "magic wand" framing removes pragmatic filters and gets to the honest answer.

Question 12 asks for the single biggest bottleneck or process failure, with an estimate of cost or time lost. This question produces the data you need to build a business case. When employees themselves are estimating the cost of a broken process, the ROI conversation becomes grounded in lived experience rather than consultant projections.

Together, questions 11 and 12 give you the data to answer the three questions every AI implementation requires: *Where does AI create the most value? What does success look like? How do we measure it?*

Conducting a Thematic Analysis — Turning Responses Into a Culture Change Roadmap

The questionnaire is most powerful when aggregated. Here is how to run a basic thematic analysis that turns 15-30 individual responses into an organizational action plan.

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Step 1 — Score the Maturity Distribution (10 min)
Tally question 3 responses. Plot your team on the maturity scale. What is the median? What is the range? Are most people at Level 2 (Curious) or Level 3 (Functional)? This tells you the appropriate starting point for your 100-day plan.

Step 2 — Surface the Perception Gap (5 min)
Compare question 6 and 7 responses to what you know to be true as a leader. If people perceive lower capability or weaker strategy than you know exists, you have a communication gap. That is a leadership action item, not a training action item.

Step 3 — Map the Pain Points (15 min)
Read all responses to question 10. Highlight recurring themes. Write each unique workflow on a sticky note or slide. Group them. The clusters that emerge — especially those appearing across multiple roles — are your pilot candidates.

Step 4 — Identify the Top 3 Automation Opportunities (10 min)
Read questions 11 and 12 together. Look for convergence. Where do people's magic-wand wishes align with their identified bottlenecks? That intersection is your highest-confidence AI implementation target.

Step 5 — Build Your Implementation Priority Matrix (5 min)
Plot your top 3-5 opportunities on a simple 2×2: Impact (High/Low) vs. Feasibility (High/Low). Start with High Impact, High Feasibility — these are your Day 1-30 pilots in the 100-day playbook.

The goal of this exercise is not a perfect analysis. It is a shared, evidence-based starting point. When a team of 20 people has collectively named their pain points, their aspirations, and their capability gaps — and those responses are reflected back to them as a group — something important happens culturally: people feel heard, and the AI initiative stops feeling like something being done to them. It starts feeling like something they helped design.

That shift — from AI as imposition to AI as response — is the foundation of sustainable culture change.

Chapter Summary

Change management is not the soft side of AI adoption. It is the whole game.

The technology works. The people are capable. The question — always the question — is whether the organizational conditions exist for individual action to become collective behavior. Whether the Champions have platforms. Whether the permission is real. Whether the governance enables rather than paralyzes. Whether the leaders are modeling rather than mandating.

BankUnited has something that most organizations never get: a workforce that already operates with high professional standards, genuine client commitment, and a culture of excellence that has been building since 2009. That culture is not an obstacle to AI adoption. It is the raw material that makes AI adoption sustainable — because when professionals with those standards apply AI to their work, they do not lower their standards to match the AI's output. They raise the AI's output to match their standards.

The frameworks in this chapter — Kotter, ADKAR, Bridges — are not the answer. They are the map. You are the navigator. And the destination is a BankUnited where AI-empowered professionals are the standard, not the exception.

The 100 days starts whenever you decide it starts.

Chapter 3 — Key Takeaways

1. *The organizations capturing AI returns redesigned their workflows. Technology adoption without workflow redesign produces minimal results.*
2. *Change fails for five specific reasons — all of them organizational, none of them technical.*
3. *Kotter provides the staircase, ADKAR provides the individual journey, Bridges provides the emotional truth. Use all three.*
4. *AI Champions should be credible peers, not tech specialists. Find them. Equip them. Give them a platform.*
5. *The four resistance archetypes require four different leadership moves. One intervention doesn't work for all four.*
6. *Communication patterns determine whether people feel AI is happening to them or for them — leaders own that.*
7. *The 100-day playbook: 30 days of awareness, 30 days of pilots, 30 days of scale.*
8. *Governance should be proportional to risk. Go with guardrails — not wait with approval.*

Resources for Chapter 3

- *Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat: [m365.cloud.microsoft (https://m365.cloud.microsoft)](https://m365.cloud.microsoft)*
- *Microsoft 365 Copilot Adoption Hub: [adoption.microsoft.com/copilot (https://adoption.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/)](https://adoption.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/)*
- *Prosci ADKAR Model: [prosci.com/adkar (https://www.prosci.com/methodology/adkar)](https://www.prosci.com/methodology/adkar)*
- *John Kotter, Leading Change — the foundational text on organizational transformation*
- *William Bridges, Managing Transitions — the emotional truth behind organizational change*
- *BCG AI Adoption in Financial Services: [bcg.com (https://www.bcg.com)](https://www.bcg.com)*

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 AI Champion
  A credible, curious, and publicly-learning professional
who models AI adoption within their team or department,
making it safe for others to experiment by sharing both
successes and failures.

ADKAR
  A change management model (Prosci) describing the five
individual conditions required for sustainable behavior
change: Awareness, Desire, Knowledge, Ability,
Reinforcement.

Kotter's 8-Step Model
  A framework for organizational transformation
identifying eight sequential conditions required for
change to take hold — from creating urgency to
institutionalizing the new behavior.

Bridges' Transitions Model
  A change model distinguishing between external change
```

(events) **and** **internal** transition (the psychological journey) — comprising three phases: Endings, the Neutral **Zone**, **and** **New** Beginnings.

AI Readiness 2×2

A team diagnostic tool **mapping** individuals **on** two axes (AI skill **level** **and** willingness **to** change) **to** identify Champions, Eager Learners, Coachable Stars, **and** Skeptics — **each** requiring different leadership responses.

Permission Gap

The organizational condition **in** which employees want **to** engage **with** AI but have **not** received clear, explicit permission **to** experiment, fail, **and** learn **in** that **domain**.

Proportional Governance

The principle that AI governance intensity should match the risk **level** **of** the specific use **case** — applying **full** compliance rigor **to** high-risk workflows **while** providing a fast lane **for** inherently low-risk AI use.

Floor Captain Model

An AI adoption approach (pioneered at JPMorgan Chase) **in** which identified enthusiasts are available **within** **each** department **to** demonstrate, support, **and** celebrate colleagues' AI experiments without a formal training mandate.